

Justices question parties' funding limits

The Supreme Court's conservatives appear ready to strike down a Watergate-era law.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court's conservatives signaled Tuesday they are likely to rule for Republicans and President Trump by throwing out a Watergate-era limit on campaign funding by political parties.

The court has repeatedly said campaign money is protected as free speech, and the new ruling could allow parties to support their candidate's campaigns with help from wealthy donors.

For the second day in a row, Trump administration lawyers urged the justices to strike down a law passed by Congress. And they appeared to have the support of most of the conservatives.

The only doubt arose over the question of whether the case was flawed because no current candidate was challenging the limits.

"The parties are very much weakened," said Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh. "This court's decisions over the years have together reduced the power of political parties, as compared to outside groups, with negative effects on our constitutional democracy."

He was referring to rulings that upheld unlimited campaign spending by wealthy donors and so-called super PACs.

In the Citizens United case of 2010, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. and four other conservatives struck down the long-standing limits on campaign spending, including by corporations and unions. They did so on the theory that such spending was "independent" of candidates and was protected as free speech under the 1st Amendment.

They said the limits on [See Justices, A7]



California Department of Fish and Wildlife



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

SIERRA NEVADA bighorn sheep, top, were listed as federally endangered in 1999. Above, a scientist surveys a wildlife crossing in the Eastern Sierra.

Killing mountain lions to save bighorn sheep

State quietly changes policy to manage wildlife

By LILA SEIDMAN

In a move that reverses nearly a decade of practice, California wildlife officials have quietly begun to allow killing mountain lions in order to protect another iconic native: bighorn sheep.

Though limited to the Eastern Sierra — the steep, rugged home of a rare type of the wild sheep — it marks a sea change for California, where legislators and voters have heaped protections on the big, charismatic cats that suffered decades of persecution.

It's a complex story — a lesson in ecosystems that involves three linked species and efforts to do right by all of them.

While some people are thrilled, many are dismayed. Some think it's the wrong tack while others say it doesn't go far

enough to safeguard yet another beloved animal: deer.

The policy change came into relief this year. In the craggy Sierra Nevada, a male lion was suspected of hunting down bighorn. Officials GPS-collared him, and he killed another sheep.

He was young enough that he hadn't started breeding or established a home range, so wildlife officials captured him and hauled him to what was supposed to be his new home.

But about six months later, he wandered back to sheep country and began killing again.

So early this summer they put him down by lethal injection, according to Tom Stephenson, who leads the Sierra Nevada bighorn [See Sierra, A8]



CARLIN STIEHL Los Angeles Times

CROSSWALK painting has been an ongoing issue. Above, an activist paints an intersection in August.

Vandalism vs. safety in crosswalk debate

Tired of delays, group paints a Westwood intersection. LAPD cites one activist.

By SUHAUNA HUSSAIN

Jonathan Hale and more than a dozen other activists were halfway through painting a third crosswalk at an intersection in Westwood on Sunday when two police cars pulled up.

Los Angeles Police Department officers told the group to stop painting and cuffed Hale, video posted to social media shows.

"Leave him alone. He's not doing anything wrong," says a woman out of frame.

"You're vandalizing city property without a permit so [I'll] ask y'all nicely. Ya'll can record all you want, but back up or I will take everybody to jail," an officer says as Hale is cuffed.

Hale was cited with a misdemeanor of vandalizing property. He has a Jan. 5 court date.

The arrest marks the latest clash between the city of Los Angeles and civilian traffic safety advocates who are frustrated by the delays in getting street intersections painted and are taking it upon themselves to do the work they say can't wait. The tension comes as the city struggles to reduce pedestrian deaths.

Hale's group is dubbed [See Crosswalk, A10]

L.A. ranks No. 1 in GoFundMe giving

Among states in 2025, California is first in terms of repeat donors, report says.

By GRACE TOOHEY

During a tumultuous year marked by several crises — most notably the devastating January wildfires — Californians, and Angelenos in particular, responded with generosity, being the most likely to have been repeat donors to GoFundMe fundraisers in 2025, the company announced.

GoFundMe's "Year in Help" report, published Tuesday, ranked California as the most generous state and Los Angeles County as the most generous community, based on the percent of repeat donors to GoFundMe charities or crowdsourced fundraisers.

Four other California counties were also ranked in the top 10, with Marin ranked second, Santa Cruz eighth, Ventura ninth and Santa Barbara 10th.

"What we continue to see is that when needs grow, individuals and nonprofits respond with even more generosity," said Tim Cadogan, chief executive of GoFundMe and an Altadena resident.

"You never want your community to be affected in that way, but the promising part of it is when things happen, people do really step

up," he said. "We've seen that here.... It's just very hopeful that when the chips are down, people do step up."

An average of 1 in 5 California households donated to a GoFundMe fundraiser this year, the report found. Nearly 1 million Los Angeles County residents donated.

California's unprecedented year of giving began just days into 2025 as several wildfires swept across Los Angeles County, devastating the communities of Altadena and Pacific Palisades.

Three days after the firestorms began, so many donations flowed into GoFundMe from around the globe that Jan. 10 became the platform's most generous day of the year. Its 2025 Wildfire Relief Fund also be- [See GoFundMe, A10]

The best at giving their best

The 10 most generous communities in the U.S., ranked by the highest percentage of repeat donors to GoFundMe.

1. Los Angeles
2. Marin, Calif.
3. Hampshire, Mass.
4. Buncombe, N.C.
5. Kings, N.Y.
6. Ulster, N.Y.
7. Chittenden, Vt.
8. Santa Cruz
9. Ventura
10. Santa Barbara

In Warner bids, workers may be the biggest losers

Netflix and Paramount acquisition scenarios differ, but both plans entail cost cutting.

By MEG JAMES AND SAMANTHA MASUNAGA

Employment in Hollywood has already been bleak. But with the impending sale of Warner — whether it's the whole company to Paramount or the studios, HBO and HBO Max to Netflix — that picture could become even dimmer.

Industry workers fear that a consolidation between two major players in Hollywood could further decrease production and lead to the sweeping job cuts that typically occur after big corporate acquisitions. Many have pointed to the downsizing that followed Walt Disney Co.'s \$71-billion purchase in 2019 of much of Rupert Murdoch's Fox entertainment assets.

More than 4,000 people lost their jobs, according to industry sources. As part of the tie-up, Disney dramatically scaled back the staff and movie pipeline at the once prolific 20th Century Fox movie studio and eventually folded much of Fox's TV production operations into an ABC-led studio. A

parade of film executives shuffled out the door.

"We've seen this play out," said Kevin Klowden, an executive director at the nonprofit Milken Institute Finance. "It's going to happen again."

Discovery's takeover of the Warner assets in 2022 also prompted successive rounds of layoffs, and the Larry Ellison family's purchase in August of Paramount has prompted more than 2,000 job cuts.

Both Netflix and Paramount have told Wall Street analysts that their takeover plans for Warner would involve cost cutting.

Paramount has promised more than \$6 billion in cuts over three years, Andy Gordon, Paramount's chief operating and chief strategy officer, told analysts during a Monday call.

"We feel confident in our \$6-billion number after doing due diligence extensively with Warner Bros.," said Gordon, a prominent former Goldman Sachs banker.

Some analysts predicted [See Warner, A13]

Hostile takeover bid put in focus

A closer look at how Paramount's attempt to buy Warner Bros. might play out. **BUSINESS, A11**

Fossil fuels off list of warming causes

EPA's revised climate change page mentions natural phenomena as the only sources.

By SETH BORENSTEIN

WASHINGTON — The Environmental Protection Agency has removed any mention of fossil fuels — the main driver of global warming — from its popular online page explaining the causes of climate change. Now it mentions only natural phenomena, even though scientists calculate that nearly all of the warming is due to human activity.

Sometime in the last few days or weeks, the EPA altered some but not all of its climate change webpages, de-emphasizing and even deleting references to the burning of coal, oil and natural gas, which scientists say is the overwhelming cause of climate change. The website's causes of climate

change page mentions changes in Earth's orbit, solar activity, Earth's reflectivity, volcanoes and natural carbon dioxide changes, but not the burning of fossil fuels. Seven scientists and three former EPA officials tell the Associated Press that this is misleading and harmful.

"Now it is completely wrong," said University of California climate scientist Daniel Swain, who also noted that impacts, risks and indicators of climate change on the EPA site are now broken links. "This was a tool that I know for a fact that a lot of educators used and a lot of people. It was actually one of the best-designed easy-access climate change information websites for the U.S."

Earlier this year, the Trump administration removed the national climate assessment from government websites.

"It is outrageous that our government is hiding information [See EPA, A10]



CHRISTIAN PETERSEN Getty Images

BULLPEN RELIEF

In a blockbuster offseason move, the Dodgers and top free-agent closer Edwin Díaz agree to a three-year, \$69-million deal. **SPORTS, B10**

Details emerge in wife's slaying

The couple, prominent landowners in the Imperial Valley, were locked in a bitter divorce. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Sunny and very warm.
L.A. Basin: 81/56 **B5**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A14**

Deadlines to ship your holiday gifts

The Postal Service, FedEx and UPS share recommended send-by dates. **BUSINESS, A11**

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